

KAVITHA KANNAN

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PROFILE

Science writer and insect biologist (PhD, honeybee behaviour and neurobiology, University of Konstanz), currently building a science writing portfolio alongside a search for opportunities in science communication and academia. Seven years of hands-on research — behavioural experimentation, fieldwork, and data analysis — inform a broad interest in animal behaviour, ecology, evolution, and neurobiology, with particular expertise in insects. Published in *The Hindu*, with further work forthcoming.

SCIENCE WRITING

- “Kingmakers: meet the insects that make India’s famed mangoes”, *The Hindu* (2026) – reported feature on wild insect pollinators and mango yield. [Read here](#)
- “The Bees that Choose to Sting”, *Club SciWri* – forthcoming feature on doctoral research into honeybee defensive behaviour.

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT & SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

- Creator, **BuzzingKavs** – science Instagram channel featuring my PhD research, and bees.
- **Featured creator, University of Konstanz Instagram** – “Fieldwork Diaries” series on South Africa fieldwork (Feb 2024).
- **Guest host, PhD Diary Instagram takeover** – week-long takeover showcasing doctoral research (Aug 2023).
- Speaker, **Soapbox Science Munich** (Jul 2023) – public talk on honeybee defensive behaviour.
- Co-organiser, **NeuroDoWo 2023** – led communications and social media strategy for the conference.
- Co-organiser, **Neralu Tree Festival, Bengaluru** (2013–2014) – youth volunteer running college awareness campaigns on urban trees and ecology; initiated the “Hug-a-Tree” campaign, which drove strong student turnout to the city’s tree festival.

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy (PhD), Biology Jul 2025
University of Konstanz, Germany

Master of Science (MSc), EUCOR Joint Master’s in Neuroscience Nov 2018
University of Strasbourg, France (courses in Strasbourg, Freiburg and Basel)

Bachelor of Science (BSc), Chemistry, Botany and Zoology Jun 2015
St. Joseph’s College of Science and Arts, Bangalore University, India

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Kannan K, Galizia CG, Nouvian M. Consistency and individuality of honeybee stinging behaviour across time and social contexts. *Royal Society Open Science*. 2025 Jan 29; 12(1):241295.

Kannan K, Galizia CG, Nouvian M. Olfactory strategies in the defensive behaviour of insects. *Insects*. 2022 May 18; 13(5):470.

Adden A, Garcia Dominguez S, Kliem K, Kannan K, et al. The evolution of lepidopteran brain morphology. *Journal of Comparative Physiology A*. 2025 Dec 22:1-24.

Honkanen A, Hensgen R, Kannan K, Adden A, et al. Parallel motion vision pathways in the brain of a tropical bee. *Journal of Comparative Physiology A*. 2023 Jul; 209(4):563–91.